CR-08 Client Evaluation Priorities and Weight Profiles

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1. Document metadata

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Purpose and scope: explain how clients set criterion weights, show illustrative profiles and a sensitivity example computed by the scoring engine.

2. Executive summary

Clients can change the five criterion weights; the system normalizes them and validates that the total is positive. A sensitivity example shows how rankings for JOB-001 change under four profiles.

3. Why clients set weights

Clients value criteria differently. A client with a fixed event wants deadline reliability; a client with a tight budget wants price compatibility. The scoring engine therefore accepts client weights and normalizes them (EVA-005). Weights express priorities among eligible proposals; they never override hard constraints.

4. Weight profiles (normalized)

Profile	Skill	Budget	Deadline	Experience	Reviews
Balanced (default)	30%	25%	20%	15%	10%
Budget-driven	25%	40%	15%	10%	10%
Deadline-driven	25%	15%	40%	10%	10%
Quality-driven	40%	15%	10%	25%	10%

Profiles are illustrative starting points. A custom entry is divided by its sum, so raw values such as 40, 30, 10, 10, 10 give the same result as 0.4, 0.3, 0.1, 0.1, 0.1.

5. Custom weights in the fictional jobs

Job	Weights used (normalized)
JOB-001	skill 30.0%; budget 25.0%; deadline 20.0%; experience 15.0%; reviews 10.0%
JOB-002	skill 25.0%; budget 20.0%; deadline 35.0%; experience 10.0%; reviews 10.0%
JOB-008	skill 35.0%; budget 30.0%; deadline 20.0%; experience 10.0%; reviews 5.0%

JOB-002 has a hard conference deadline and gives deadline compatibility 35 percent. JOB-008 gives skill match 35 percent and budget 30 percent because the fix must be precise and inexpensive.

6. Sensitivity example: proposals for JOB-001 under four profiles

Overall scores computed by the deterministic engine for the four proposals of JOB-001 (snapshot values). Status column shows the eligibility status, which is independent of the profile.

Proposal	Freelancer	Balanced	Budget-driven	Deadline-driven	Quality-driven	Status
PRP-001	FRE-001	79.3	79.9	74.9	82.0	ELIGIBLE_WITH_FLAGS
PRP-002	FRE-003	68.6	69.4	66.9	69.2	HOLD_PENDING_EVIDENCE
PRP-003	FRE-002	57.2	62.1	57.1	51.5	HOLD_PENDING_EVIDENCE
PRP-004	FRE-006	44.3	51.7	46.7	33.6	HOLD_PENDING_EVIDENCE

Profile	Ranking by overall score (before status handling)
Balanced (default)	PRP-001 > PRP-002 > PRP-003 > PRP-004
Budget-driven	PRP-001 > PRP-002 > PRP-003 > PRP-004
Deadline-driven	PRP-001 > PRP-002 > PRP-003 > PRP-004
Quality-driven	PRP-001 > PRP-002 > PRP-003 > PRP-004

Interpretation: the ranking is stable when the same proposal leads under every profile; when it changes, the explanation should say which criterion caused the change. Proposals with status HOLD_PENDING_EVIDENCE or INELIGIBLE_HARD_CONSTRAINT are listed separately even when their weighted score is high.

7. Validation rules for client weights

- Weights must not be negative.
- The sum must be greater than zero; otherwise the request is rejected.
- A weight of zero removes the criterion from the calculation.
- If a criterion has no data (for example no reviews) its weight is removed and the rest renormalized.
- Changing weights must not change hard-constraint status.

8. Guidance for choosing weights

- Give extra weight only to criteria that a client can verify later.
- Avoid putting more than 50 percent on one criterion unless it is a true priority.
- Review the effect on ranking before publishing.

9. Summary of key findings

- Weights are normalized and never override hard constraints.
- Sensitivity analysis explains rank changes.
- Zero weights remove a criterion.

10. Keywords and alternative terminology

weights; client priorities; weight profile; normalization; sensitivity analysis; budget-driven; deadline-driven; custom weights